

LCB TRAINING

BASEBALL ATHLETE NUTRITION GUIDE

Fuel Right. Perform Better.

What to eat before and after the game to maximize your energy, focus, and recovery.

All Ages | Game Day Nutrition | Coach Broc Approved

Why Nutrition Matters for Baseball Athletes

Baseball is a sport of explosive moments — a sprint to first base, a diving catch, a powerful swing. What you eat directly impacts how fast you react, how hard you can compete, and how quickly you recover. Most young athletes show up to games under-fueled or having eaten the wrong things at the wrong time. This guide gives you a simple, practical framework for fueling your body before and after competition so you can perform at your best every single game.

The Big 3 — What Every Athlete Needs

Every meal and snack should include a balance of these three macronutrients:

Macronutrient	What It Does	Best Sources
Carbohydrates	Your primary energy source. Fuels your muscles and brain during competition.	Rice, pasta, oatmeal, bread, fruit, sweet potato
Protein	Builds and repairs muscle. Critical for recovery after games and practice.	Chicken, turkey, eggs, Greek yogurt, milk, tuna
Healthy Fats	Sustained energy, joint health, and brain function during long games.	Peanut butter, almonds, avocado, olive oil, whole eggs

Pre-Game Nutrition — Fuel to Compete

What you eat before a game determines your energy level, focus, and how your body feels in the late innings. The goal is to top off your energy stores without feeling heavy or sluggish. Timing matters as much as what you eat.

Timing	What to Eat	Why It Works
3-4 hours before	Full balanced meal — grilled chicken or turkey, rice or pasta, vegetables, water	Gives your body time to digest fully so you feel light and energized at game time
1-2 hours before	Light snack — peanut butter on toast, banana with almond butter, Greek yogurt with fruit	Quick energy boost without weighing you down or causing stomach issues
30-45 min before	Quick carb — banana, handful of pretzels, a few crackers, sports drink if needed	Fast fuel for immediate energy, easy on the stomach

✓ Great Pre-Game Foods

- Oatmeal with banana and honey
- Chicken and rice bowl
- Turkey sandwich on whole grain bread
- Greek yogurt with granola
- Pasta with light tomato sauce
- Peanut butter on toast
- Apple or banana with nut butter
- Low-fat chocolate milk

✗ Avoid Before Games

- Fast food burgers and fries
- Greasy or fried foods
- Heavy cream sauces or alfredo
- Large amounts of dairy
- Sugary candy or soda
- Energy drinks
- Spicy foods
- Anything you have never eaten before a game

Hydration — The Most Overlooked Performance Tool

Dehydration of just 2% of your body weight can reduce performance, slow reaction time, and affect focus. Most athletes are already slightly dehydrated before they even step on the field. Water is your best tool — not energy drinks, not soda.

When	How Much	Notes
------	----------	-------

Night before the game	Drink plenty of water throughout the day	Pre-hydrating the day before matters as much as game day
Morning of the game	16-20 oz upon waking	Your body loses water overnight — rehydrate first thing
2 hours before first pitch	16 oz of water	Gives kidneys time to process before you compete
During the game	6-8 oz every inning in the dugout	Sip consistently — do not chug large amounts at once

Post-Game Nutrition — Recover to Come Back Stronger

The 30-60 minutes after a game is your recovery window. Your muscles are depleted and ready to absorb nutrients. What you eat in this window directly affects how sore you are the next day and how quickly you bounce back for the next game or practice. Do not skip this.

Timing	What to Eat	Why It Works
Within 30 min	Quick protein and carb combo — chocolate milk, protein shake with banana, Greek yogurt with fruit	Starts the muscle repair process immediately while your body is most receptive
1-2 hours after	Full balanced meal — lean protein, complex carbs, vegetables, plenty of water	Replenishes energy stores and provides amino acids for full muscle recovery
Before bed	Light protein snack if hungry — cottage cheese, Greek yogurt, or glass of milk	Slow-digesting protein supports overnight muscle repair while you sleep

✓ Great Post-Game Foods

- Chocolate milk (the original recovery drink)
- Grilled chicken with rice and veggies
- Turkey wrap with avocado
- Eggs and whole grain toast
- Salmon with sweet potato
- Greek yogurt with berries and granola
- Tuna on whole wheat crackers
- Protein smoothie with fruit and milk

✗ Avoid After Games

- Fast food as your main recovery meal
- Skipping the recovery window entirely
- Heavy sugary desserts immediately after
- Going straight to bed without eating
- Soda or sugary drinks instead of water
- Large amounts of processed or packaged snacks

Coach Broc's Tips

- Consistency beats perfection. Eating well 80% of the time is better than trying to be perfect and giving up.
- Never try a new food on game day. Stick to what you know works for your body.
- Chocolate milk is one of the best post-game recovery drinks available — perfect ratio of protein to carbs.
- If you play doubleheaders, bring snacks between games — a banana, PB&J, or granola bar keeps your energy up.
- Your parents and coaches can help you plan game day meals. Show them this guide.
- Sleep is part of nutrition. Your body recovers and grows while you sleep — 8-9 hours is the target for athletes.

Want personal coaching from Coach Broc?

Get full access to swing analysis, mental game support, and personalized coaching at lcbtraining.com

lcbtraining.com